



# Bonsai



**Crab apple**

*Each miniature apple is up to  $\frac{7}{8}$  in (1 cm) across, about one-fifth the size of a regular crab apple.*



The **smallest bonsai** grows just **2 in** (5 cm) tall.



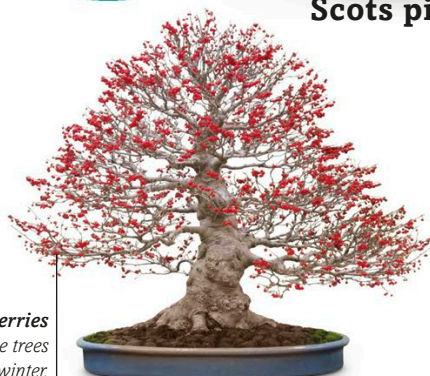
**Scots pine**

*Dense growth on top makes this a favorite among bonsai lovers.*

**Satsuki azalea**



*These funnel-shaped flowers can range from under  $\frac{1}{8}$  in (2 cm) to  $6\frac{3}{4}$  in (17 cm) across.*



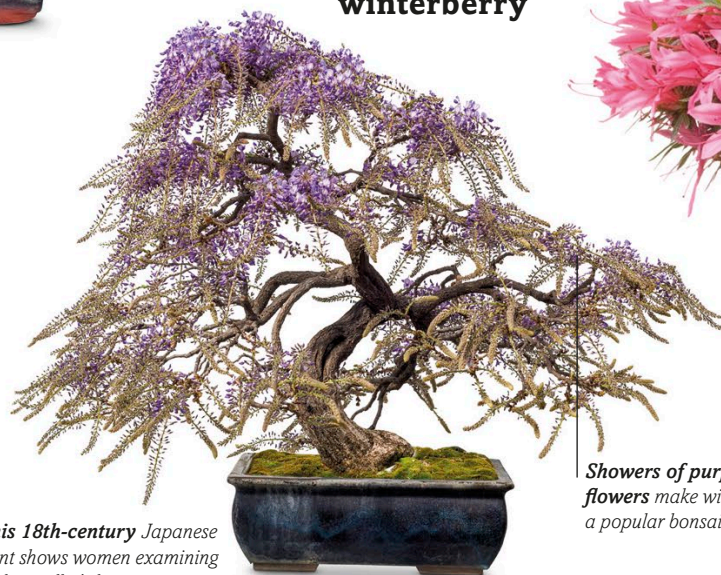
**Japanese winterberry**

*Bright red berries cover female trees throughout the winter.*



**Bonsai seller**

*This 18th-century Japanese print shows women examining a plant seller's bonsai.*



**Japanese wisteria**

*Showers of purple flowers make wisteria a popular bonsai vine.*

The word “bonsai” means “planted in a container” and is the Asian art of growing miniature trees. The small pot helps restrict growth, while the branches are skillfully pruned to keep the plant small and mimic the natural shape of the full-size tree.

Although they usually reach a height of only 5–10 in (13–25 cm), bonsai trees bear flowers and fruit. Some species, such as the **Japanese wisteria** and **satsuki azalea**, are particularly popular for their beautiful displays of flowers, while others, including **crab apples** and **dwarf pomegranates**, produce tiny fruits. Bonsai